2.6 Registering a route

When a user visits a URL controlled by Django, the web server calls the WSGI application defined in wsgi.py with the HTTP request information. Django uses its list of URL patterns defined in urls.py and tries to find a match. If a match gets found, the view associated with the URL pattern gets called. You have defined the home app with the `credits()` view in its views.py file; now, you need to register a URL route with that view.

The URL mappings in urls.py are contained in a list called `urlpatterns`. You define a mapping using a `path` object. When you used the `startproject` command to create your project, a bare-bones urls.py file got created. That generated file includes the import for `path` objects. Each `path` object requires at least two arguments: a URL pattern and a mapping. The mapping, in this case, is a reference to your `credits()` function. Mappings can also be references to other mapping files, giving the ability to create hierarchies of maps.

Your path object requires an actual reference to the `credits()` view—yes, the callable view function itself. Importing every view in your project would take up a lot of space, so it is common practice to import the view module and then dot-reference the function inside.

RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py is the central place for all URL definitions. All apps register routes in this file, and because every app names its view file views.py, this can get confusing. To make your urls.py clearer, use the `import … as` pattern to rename your imported module. For example, instead of using `from home import views`, you rename the imported module as `from home import views as home_views`.

Django includes a management tool called the Django Admin—not to be confused with the `django-admin` command, which is completely unrelated. By default, the `urlpatterns` list includes a mapping for the Django Admin. When you register your credits view, you'll be adding this along with the existing mapping. To do this, open RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py and change it to look like the following listing. A future chapter covers the Django Admin in detail.

Listing 2.3 Register your view

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py
from django.contrib import admin

from django.urls import path

from home import views as home_views

urlpatterns = [
    path("admin/", admin.site.urls),
    path('credits/', home_views.credits),
]
```

Import the home app, aliasing it.

Register the credits view function in the home app against the 'credits/' path.

Note the lack of a leading slash (/) in the `path` pattern. Django prefixes the leading slash for you. The URL /credits/ is registered using `path("credits/")`. To register